Top 50 Linux Commands You Must Know as a Regular User

1. **ls** - The most frequently used command in Linux to list directories
2. **pwd** - Print working directory command in Linux
3. **cd** - Linux command to navigate through directories
4. **mkdir** - Command used to create directories in Linux
5. **mv** - Move or rename files in Linux
6. **cp** - Similar usage as mv but for copying files in Linux
7. **rm** - Delete files or directories
8. **touch** - Create blank/empty files
9. **ln** - Create symbolic links (shortcuts) to other files
10. **clear** - Clear the terminal display
11. **cat** - Display file contents on the terminal
12. **echo** - Print any text that follows the command
13. **less** - Linux command to display paged outputs in the terminal
14. **man** - Access manual pages for all Linux commands
15. **uname** - Linux command to get basic information about the OS
16. **whoami** - Get the active username
17. **tar** - Command to extract and compress files in linux
18. **grep** - Search for a string within an output
19. **head** - Return the specified number of lines from the top
20. **tail** - Return the specified number of lines from the bottom
21. **diff** - Find the difference between two files
22. **cmp** - Allows you to check if two files are identical
23. **comm** - Combines the functionality of diff and cmp
24. **sort** - Linux command to sort the content of a file while outputting
25. **export** - Export environment variables in Linux
26. **zip** - Zip files in Linux
27. **unzip** - Unzip files in Linux
28. **ssh** - Secure Shell command in Linux
29. **service** - Linux command to start and stop services
30. **ps** - Display active processes
31. **kill and killall** - Kill active processes by process ID or name
32. **df** - Display disk filesystem information
33. **mount** - Mount file systems in Linux
34. **chmod** - Command to change file permissions
35. **chown** - Command for granting ownership of files or folders
36. **ifconfig** - Display network interfaces and IP addresses
37. **traceroute** - Trace all the network hops to reach the destination
38. **wget** - Direct download files from the internet
39. **ufw** - Firewall command
40. **iptables** - Base firewall for all other firewall utilities to interface with
41. **apt, pacman, yum, rpm** - Package managers depending on the distribution
42. **sudo** - Command to escalate privileges in Linux
43. **cal** - View a command-line calendar
44. **alias -** Create custom shortcuts for your regularly used commands
45. **dd** - Majorly used for creating bootable USB sticks
46. **whereis** - Locate the binary, source, and manual pages for a command
47. **whatis** - Find what a command is used for
48. **top** - View active processes live with their system usage
49. **useradd and usermod** - Add a new user or change existing user data
50. **passwd** - Create or update passwords for existing users

File and Directory Commands

Command	Description	Example
ls	List directory contents.	ls
cd	Change directory.	cd /path/to/directory
pwd	Show current directory.	pwd
mkdir	Create a new directory.	mkdir new_directory
rmdir	Remove an empty directory.	rmdir empty_directory
rm	Delete files or directories.	rm file.txt
touch	Create an empty file.	touch new_file.txt
cp	Copy files or directories.	cp file.txt /path/to/destination
mv	Move or rename files.	mv file.txt /path/to/new_location
cat	Display file contents.	cat file.txt
nano / vim	Edit files in terminal.	nano file.txt
find	Search for files in a directory hierarchy.	find . -name "file.txt"

Command	Description	Example
grep	Search text using patterns.	grep "pattern" file.txt
tar	Archive and compress files.	tar -cvf archive.tar file1.txt file2.txt
df	Show disk usage of file systems.	df
du	Show directory/file size.	du -sh /path/to/directory
chmod	Change file permissions.	chmod 755 file.txt
chown	Change file owner.	chown user:group file.txt
mount	Mount a filesystem.	mount /dev/sdb1 /mnt
umount	Unmount a filesystem.	umount /mnt

Networking Commands

Command	Description	Sample Usage
ping	Test connectivity to a host.	ping google.com
ifconfig / ip a	Display network interfaces.	ifconfig or ip a
netstat / ss	Show network connections.	netstat -tuln or ss -tuln

Command	Description	Sample Usage
wget	Download files via HTTP/FTP.	wget http://example.com/file.zip
curl	Transfer data using URL syntax.	curl -O http://example.com/file.zip
nc (Netcat)	Network debugging and data transfer.	nc -zv 192.168.1.1 80
tcpdump	Capture and analyze network packets.	tcpdump -i eth0
iptables	Configure firewall rules.	iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT
traceroute	Trace the path packets take to a network host.	traceroute example.com
nslookup	Query DNS to obtain domain name or IP address mapping.	nslookup example.com
ssh	Securely connect to a remote host.	ssh user@example.com

Process and System Monitoring Commands

Command	Description	Example Command
ps	Show running processes.	ps aux
top	Dynamic process viewer.	top

Command	Description	Example Command
htop	Enhanced version of top.	htop
kill	Send a signal to a process.	kill <PID>
killall	Kill processes by name.	killall <process_name>
uptime	System uptime and load.	uptime
whoami	Current logged-in user.	whoami
env	Display environment variables.	env
strace	Trace system calls of a process.	strace -p <PID>
systemctl	Manage systemd services.	systemctl status <service_name>
journalctl	View system logs.	journalctl -xe
free	Display memory usage.	free -h
vmstat	Report virtual memory statistics.	vmstat 1

Command	Description	Example Command
iostat	Report CPU and I/O statistics.	iostat
lsof	List open files by processes.	lsof
dmesg	Print kernel ring buffer messages.	dmesg

User and Permission Management Commands

Command	Description	Example Command
passwd	Change user password.	passwd <username>
adduser / useradd	Add a new user.	adduser <username> or useradd <username>
deluser / userdel	Delete a user.	deluser <username> or userdel <username>
usermod	Modify user account.	usermod -aG <group> <username>
groups	Show group memberships.	groups <username>
sudo	Execute commands as root.	sudo <command>
chage	Change user password expiry information.	chage -l <username>

Command	Description	Example Command
id	Display user identity information.	id <username>
newgrp	Log in to a new group.	newgrp <group>

File Transfer and Synchronization Commands

Command	Description	Example Command
scp	Securely copy files over SSH.	scp user@remote:/path/to/file /local/destination
rsync	Efficiently sync files and directories.	rsync -avz /local/directory/ user@remote:/path/to/destination
ftp	Transfer files using the File Transfer Protocol.	ftp ftp.example.com
sftp	Securely transfer files using SSH File Transfer Protocol.	sftp user@remote:/path/to/file
wget	Download files from the web.	wget http://example.com/file.zip
curl	Transfer data from or to a server.	curl -O http://example.com/file.zip

Text Processing Commands

Command	Description	Example Command
awk	Pattern scanning and processing.	awk '{print $1}' file.txt

Command	Description	Example Command
sed	Stream editor for filtering/modifying text.	sed 's/old/new/g' file.txt
cut	Remove sections from lines of text.	cut -d':' -f1 /etc/passwd
sort	Sort lines of text.	sort file.txt
grep	Search for patterns in text.	grep 'pattern' file.txt
wc	Count words, lines, and characters.	wc -l file.txt
paste	Merge lines of files.	paste file1.txt file2.txt
join	Join lines of two files on a common field.	join file1.txt file2.txt
head	Output the first part of files.	head -n 10 file.txt
tail	Output the last part of files.	tail -n 10 file.txt

Shell Utilities and Shortcuts Commands

Command	Description	Example Command
alias	Create shortcuts for commands.	alias ll='ls -la'
unalias	Remove an alias.	unalias ll

Command	Description	Example Command
history	Show previously entered commands.	history
clear	Clear the terminal screen.	clear
reboot	Reboot the system.	reboot
shutdown	Power off the system.	shutdown now
date	Display or set the system date and time.	date
echo	Display a line of text.	echo "Hello, World!"
sleep	Delay for a specified amount of time.	sleep 5
time	Measure the duration of command execution.	time ls
watch	Execute a program periodically, showing output fullscreen.	watch -n 5 df -h

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